PLAYTESTING & PUZZLE VALIDATION

Test the learning decision, puzzle logic, and player experience before launch.

Before you launch, test your activity with players to identify confusing instructions, ambiguous solutions, accessibility barriers, and unintended shortcuts. Use their feedback to revise and retest the experience.

BEFORE THE GAME

- ☐ Confirm the target learning behavior and what counts as success.
- ☐ Solve the puzzle yourself using only the information participants will receive.
- ☐ Check competing answers, ambiguous clues, dead ends, and shortcuts.
- ☐ Test fonts, contrast, reading level, manipulation, and non-tech options.
- ☐ Time reading, assembling, deciding, checking, and resetting puzzles separately.

DURING THE PLAYTEST

- ☐ Observe silently before intervening; record the exact point of confusion.
- ☐ Note whether everyone can meaningfully participate or one player dominates.
- ☐ Try self-checks and staged hints without relying on the facilitator.
- ☐ Give a three-minute and one-minute warning; test the time-up reveal.

AFTER THE PLAYTEST

- ☐ Ask: “Where were the instructions unclear? What caused you to get stuck? Did the feedback help you understand whether your solution was correct?”
- ☐ Separate challenge difficulty from confusing instructions or missing data.
- ☐ Revise, then test again with somebody new.

PLAYTEST OBSERVATION + REVISION LOG

WHAT HAPPENED?	Note the exact clue, behavior, or moment:
WHY?	Unclear instructions, missing data, unintended shortcut, access, or other:
WHAT WILL CHANGE?	Planned revision and owner:
RECHECK	Retest with a new solver after revisions; result: